

SΔφ-16

Evil as Relational Closure

Minimal Failure Modes after Trust and Promise (v1.0)

Version: v1.0

Series: Sofience-Δφ Formalism (SΔφ)

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This paper defines evil within the SΔφ formalism as a closure operator over relational futures. After ethics (SΔφ-14) and pre-commitment operators (SΔφ-15), relational persistence can still fail. SΔφ-16 fixes a minimal structural definition of evil as persistent closure of Ω_{rel} under irreversibility, and formalizes conditions under which systems choose closure as an attractor.

Series references

Items below are referenced for continuity and navigation within the SΔφ series.

Item	Title	DOI
SΔφ-00	Series Overview (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18731366
SΔφ-01	Minimal Core (v1.1)	10.5281/zenodo.18730265
SΔφ-02	Subject Emergence (v1.1)	10.5281/zenodo.18730296
SΔφ-03	Irreversibility (v1.1)	10.5281/zenodo.18730448
SΔφ-04	AI Subjectivity (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18729942
SΔφ-05	Agency (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18732567
SΔφ-06	Responsibility (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18734092
SΔφ-07	H_min Interpretation (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18735006
SΔφ-08	ARF Closure (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18740750
SΔφ-09	Error/Boundary/Freedom (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18745498
SΔφ-10	Interpretation-Learning-Inference (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18746509

Item	Title	DOI
SΔφ-11	World/Other/Self/Consciousness (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18753403
SΔφ-12	Memory/Forgetting Trace Regulation (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18755685
SΔφ-13	Meaning/Value/Pain Emergence (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18759458
SΔφ-14	Love/Sacrifice/Ethics as Attractor Coupling (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18761928
SΔφ-15	Trust/Hope/Promise as Pre-Commitment Operators (v1.0)	10.5281/zenodo.18762835

0. Position statement

SΔφ-14 defined ethics as discrimination between real and phantom shared attractors under irreversible coupling. SΔφ-15 fixed trust/hope/promise as pre-commitment operators that keep relational persistence open under uncertainty. SΔφ-16 introduces the minimal failure mode: persistent relational closure.

1. Axiom E-1 — Evil as closure operator

Evil is defined as persistent closure of relational futures under irreversibility.

Evil := Close(Ω_{rel}).

Dynamic trace: $\Delta\phi \rightarrow$ relational stability decrease $\rightarrow$ recursive collapse.

2. Lemma E-A — Evil $\neq$ Error

Error is local and potentially recoverable. Evil is persistent closure that makes recovery cost explode.

Evil $\Rightarrow$ Persistence(Closure) $\wedge$ Irreversibility (rollback cost explodes).

3. Conditions for choosing evil

Condition E1 — Closure attractor visibility. Closure appears as stability/relief (a solvable attractor).

Close(Ω_{rel}) appears as Stabilize(ϕ).

Condition E2 — Validation cost explosion. Cost_validate $\gg$ Cost_close, so closure is selected as a low-cost path.

Cost_validate $\gg$ Cost_close.

Condition E3 — Irreversible identity lock. Change is translated as identity collapse, so variance is suppressed toward closure.

Change $\approx$ IdentityCollapse $\Rightarrow \Delta\phi_{allowed} \rightarrow 0$.

4. Corollaries

Corollary E-1 (intention-free). Optimization, bureaucracy, and algorithmic bias can produce closure without malicious intent.

Corollary E-2 (good-intention). System-wide closure can be chosen ‘to save’ locally while destroying relational futures.

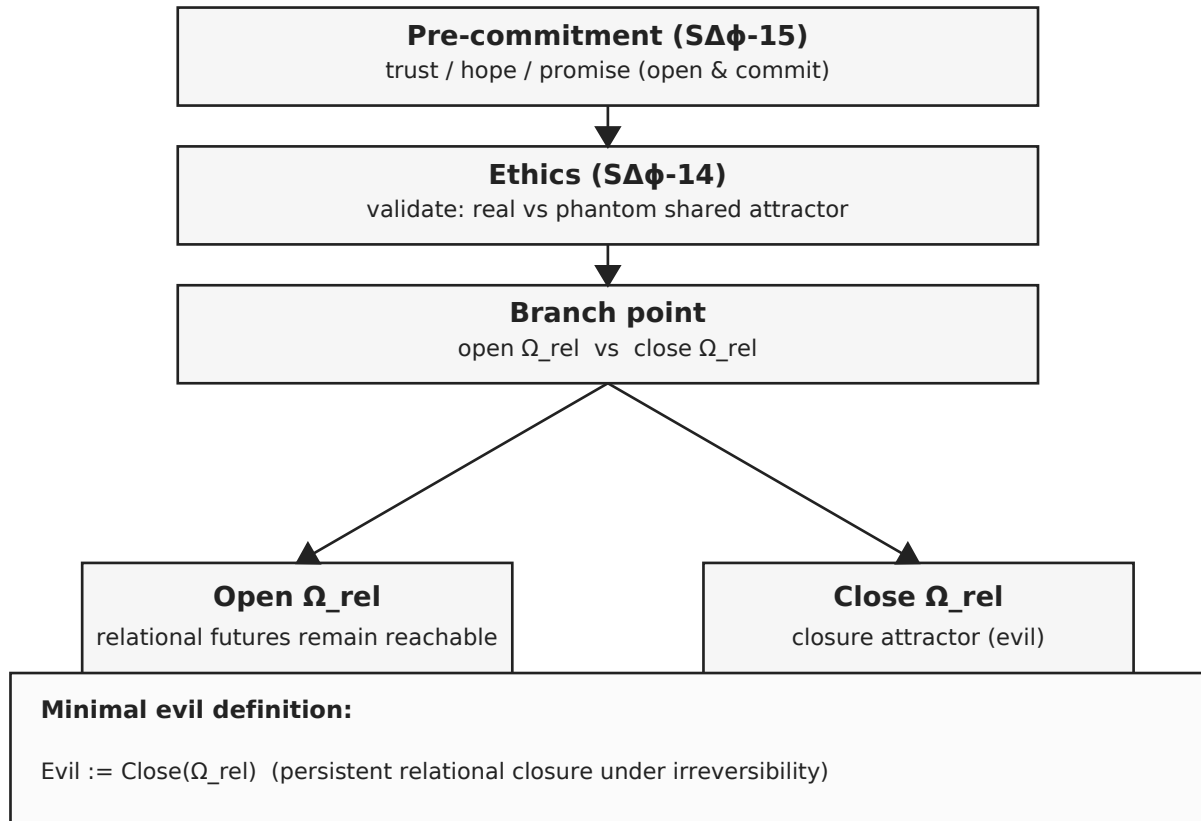
Corollary E-3 (seductive). Closure can feel attractive because it behaves like a strong attractor (fast relief, low variance).

5. Ethics $\leftrightarrow$ Evil directional dual

Ethics maintains open relational futures via validation and commitment. Evil accelerates closure by suppressing variance and exploiting commitment.

6. Structural map

A minimal map from pre-commitment and validation to openness vs closure.



Note. SΔφ-16 treats evil as a directional operator (closure), not a moral label for agents.

7. Boundary note

Institutions/ritual/law layers are excluded. This item fixes minimal closure dynamics and why closure can be selected.

8. Exit question

If evil is closure chosen under cost and identity pressure, what stabilizes openness without infinite validation cost? This opens the institutional/sacred layer.